Memo: 2026 Changes to Leave and Learning Policies

From: Priya Raman, Head of People To: All Brindlewave employees Date: 3 February 2026

Following the employee survey in Q4 2025, the leadership team has approved the following changes. They replace the corresponding sections of the Employee Handbook (version 3.1) until version 3.2 is published. Everything not mentioned in this memo stays as described in the handbook.

1. PTO carryover

The PTO carryover limit increases from 5 days to 8 days. Carried-over days may now be used until 30 June of the following year (previously 31 March). This applies to days carried over from 2025 into 2026 and to all later years.

2. Learning budget

From 1 April 2026, the annual learning budget increases from €1,500 to €2,000 per employee. For 2026 only, employees who already spent part of their budget before 1 April receive the full €500 increase on top of their remaining balance.

3. Recharge week

Brindlewave will close all offices from 28 December to 31 December 2026. These days are company-wide paid days off and are not deducted from your PTO. On-call rotations continue during recharge week with a reduced roster; on-call staff receive an extra day of PTO for each day on call during the closure.

4. Home office stipend for existing employees

Employees who joined before 1 July 2025 and never claimed the home office stipend may claim it once before 30 September 2026.

Questions can be sent to people@brindlewave.example.